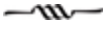
the time, but eventually the two boys, Kulathan and Arsalan, from the Indira Nagar house had died before they could be treated. And it was horrific to watch them die—it was not a painless death, as is often thought. Their bodies had started to convulse and their mouths had filled with saliva mixed with blood and vomit. And then they had passed out. The antidote might have earned them maybe thirty minutes more of life, but that was it. They were declared brought dead at the hospital. A similar situation might arise with Sivarasan and gang too.

While the tracking team was struggling to catch Sivarasan, Manoharan of the Tamil Nadu Police was busy studying old cases of the LTTE at Malligai. He discovered some DK activists in Tamil Nadu who were very close to the LTTE's political group. He shortlisted them and approached one of them for a sting operation. The man's background showed his full involvement in helping the LTTE's political group. But there was nothing to indicate his link with the INT group in Tamil Nadu. His interrogation after the sting operation revealed his links with Trichy Santhan. He was shocked to see Manoharan on his doorstep. The DIG made his intentions clear—he told the DK activist that the SIT wanted to catch Sivarasan 'alive' and wanted to talk to Trichy about it. Would he be able to convince Trichy? But he was only an activist and not a well-trained cadre or terrorist. He could not take pressure from the investigators and the round-the-clock surveillance on him and his family. He gave in.

The DK was essentially a social movement aimed at promoting a casteless society for the Tamils. The DK had actively and openly supported the Sri Lankan Tamils in their violent struggle against the Sri Lankan army. Even though there were two groups in the DK—the main group led by K. Veeramani and a splinter group led by Ramakrishnan—both had accepted the LTTE as the only representative of the Sri Lankan Tamils.



Feeling the heat, Suresh Master had got both the cars—the green Maruti Gypsy and the blue Premier Padmini Fiat—repainted in white. He knew the